

MAX ZHANG

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Education

Irvington High School: Class of 2027

Unweighted GPA: 3.97, **Weighted GPA:** 4.5

Relevant Coursework: AP Calculus BC, AP Physics 1, AP Computer Science A, AP Computer Science Principles, AP English Language and Composition, AP Psychology

Experience

Stanford Trustworthy AI Research

COLM Main Conference

STANFORD UNIVERSITY

Dec 2025 – September 2026

- Worked with Assistant Professor Sanmi Koyejo and PhD candidate Sang Truong in STAIR lab.
- Built a multi-group Item Response Theory framework to decompose and measure cross-lingual safety vulnerabilities in LLMs.
- **Max Zhang***, Ameen Patel*, Sang Truong**, Sanmi Koyejo**, *: Equal contribution, **: Equal senior authorship. Paper accepted to COLM Main Conference. [\[arXiv\]](#) [\[code\]](#)

Research Intern – Mechanistic Interpretability

Co-first Author

STANFORD UNIVERSITY

Dec 2025 – August 2026

- Worked with PhD candidate Nathan Hu to evaluate automated circuit tracing with Large Language Models.
- Extended Michael Hanna's open-source circuit tracing framework to automate the identification of interpretable circuits. Automated Graphs are featured subgraphs on Neuronpedia. [\[Neuronpedia\]](#)
- Ameen Patel*, **Max Zhang***, Nathan Hu; *: Equal contribution. Paper accepted to ICML Mechanistic Interpretability workshop. [\[OpenReview\]](#) [\[code\]](#)

Beaver Works Summer Institute (BWSI)

Participant

REMOTE

July 2026 – Aug 2026

- Selected for the Serious Games with AI (SGAI) BWSI program for July 6 – August 2, 2026. [\[certificate\]](#)
- Only participant in SGAI course nominated for a paid Internship at [\[Draper Laboratory\]](#) next summer 2027. 1 of 14 students out of 500+ participants in 14 courses.

Algoverse AI Research

Lead Author

REMOTE

June 2025 – Nov 2025

- Paper accepted to NeurIPS 2025's Workshop on Socially Responsible Foundation Models and AACL-IJCNLP 2025's Student Research Workshop for **oral presentation**.
- Applied response-based knowledge distillation via LoRA to transfer multilingual safety and its study effects.
- **Max Zhang***, Derek Liu, Kai Zhang, Joshua Franco, Haihao Liu; *: Lead author. [\[arXiv\]](#)

Trustworthy Private AI Benchmarks

Ongoing

STANFORD UNIVERSITY

Sept 2026 – Present

- Working with PhD candidate Sang Truong on the external verification of private AI benchmarks in STAIR lab.
- Contributing to a framework and meta-analysis of 44 private benchmarks characterizing how evaluations support verification of validity, integrity, and neutrality claims.

Projects

Badminton AI Form Tracker; June 2025 – April 2026: Co-built BIRDIE; labeled 300–400 images of teammates' badminton form and built a Python CV pipeline (OpenCV/PyTorch; CNN + logistic regression) to detect player form, track birdie trajectory, and provide corrective feedback. [\[view\]](#)

Code4Cause (BayHacks Winner); September 2024: Developed a collaborative calendar web app using Firebase, JavaScript, and HTML, allowing non-profits to schedule events in real time. Our project won the Code4Cause track at BayHacks (1 of 10 winners out of 200+ participants). [\[devpost\]](#)

Extracurricular Activities

Irvington Computer Science Club

Co-President

Aug 2025 – Present

- Lead organizer for Viking Hacks 2025 and 2026, one of Fremont’s largest student-led hackathons; managed logistics, judging, and sponsorship outreach. [\[link\]](#)

AMC Theatres Part-time

NEWARK, CA

Crew Member

August 2025 – Present

- Handle high-volume guest service across ticketing, concessions, and ushering in a theater environment, often resolving customer issues directly.

Other School Clubs

- Secretary (Competitive Programming Club), Secretary (Math Club), Treasurer (Philosophy Club), and Co-Founder (Movie Club).

Honors & Awards

- **USACO Gold Division:** Competitive Programming. USACO: Gold (Feb 2026); Silver (Dec 2024).
- **Supervised Machine Learning: Regression and Classification:** Completed Andrew Ng’s Coursera course. [\[certificate\]](#)
- **Badminton (National Ranking):** U17 Boys Singles/Doubles #5 (2025); Pan American Championships U15 Boys Singles Runner-up (2023)
- **President’s Volunteer Service Award Gold (x2):** For sustained volunteer hours teaching badminton and tutoring English.
- **Stanford Math Tournament 2026:** Distinguished Honorable Mention in Guts/Team Rounds